

ODM-004 — Problem Framing

Status: Foundational

Authority: Methodology

Depends on:

- ODM-000
- ODM-001
- ODM-002
- ODM-003
- OCS-000 through OCS-032
- OAS-000 through OAS-031
- OIS-000 through OIS-019
- OGD-000 through OGD-023

Purpose

This specification defines the constitutional role of Problem Framing within the Organodynamics Discovery Methodology.

Discovery does not begin by answering questions.

It begins by identifying the right question.

Problem Framing transforms observations and recognized patterns into a clearly defined object of inquiry.

A well-framed problem does not suggest an answer.

It establishes the constitutional boundaries within which meaningful answers may later emerge.

1. Objective

The objective of Problem Framing is to define the phenomenon under investigation with sufficient precision that independent researchers can investigate the same constitutional problem without presupposing the same explanation.

Problem Framing SHALL preserve:

Clarity.

Scope.

Neutrality.

Traceability.

Methodological openness.

2. Definition

Problem Framing is the methodological process of defining the constitutional phenomenon to be investigated.

A Problem Frame SHALL identify:

The observed phenomenon.

Its apparent boundaries.

The motivating observations.

The recognized patterns.

Known uncertainties.

Known exclusions.

A Problem Frame SHALL describe the question.

It SHALL not propose the answer.

3. Scope

Every Problem Frame SHALL explicitly define:

What is within scope.

What is outside scope.

Applicable constitutional concepts.

Relevant specifications.

Operational assumptions.

Known limitations.

Scope SHALL remain reviewable.

4. Research Questions

A Problem Frame SHALL formulate one or more research questions.

Questions SHOULD be:

Observable.

Answerable.

Conceptually coherent.

Methodologically neutral.

Historically traceable.

Questions SHALL remain independent of proposed explanations.

5. Relationship to Hypothesis

Problem Framing SHALL precede hypothesis generation.

Multiple hypotheses MAY arise from a single Problem Frame.

A single hypothesis SHALL identify the Problem Frame from which it emerged.

Frames and hypotheses SHALL remain independently reviewable.

6. Evolution

Problem Frames MAY evolve as additional observations become available.

Evolution SHALL preserve:

Previous formulations.

Reasons for revision.

Affected observations.

Affected patterns.

Historical continuity.

7. Verification

Verification SHALL demonstrate:

Scope correctness.

Question clarity.

Evidence traceability.

Conceptual neutrality.

Historical continuity.

Independent reproducibility.

Problem Framing SHALL remain explainable.

8. Problem Framing Test

Problem Framing satisfies this specification when independent researchers consistently identify the same constitutional phenomenon and formulate substantially equivalent research questions from the same observations and recognized patterns while remaining free to develop different hypotheses.

Conformance

A Problem Frame conforms to this specification when it defines a constitutionally relevant phenomenon with explicit scope, transparent evidence, preserved historical traceability, conceptually neutral research questions, and independently verifiable methodological integrity.

Methodological Principle

The quality of a discovery depends not only on the answers that follow,
but on the question that made those answers possible.

Problem Framing therefore protects the discipline from solving the wrong problem with increasing precision.

It reminds every researcher that before asking how reality works,
one must first determine what reality is actually asking to be understood.

End of Specification ODM-004